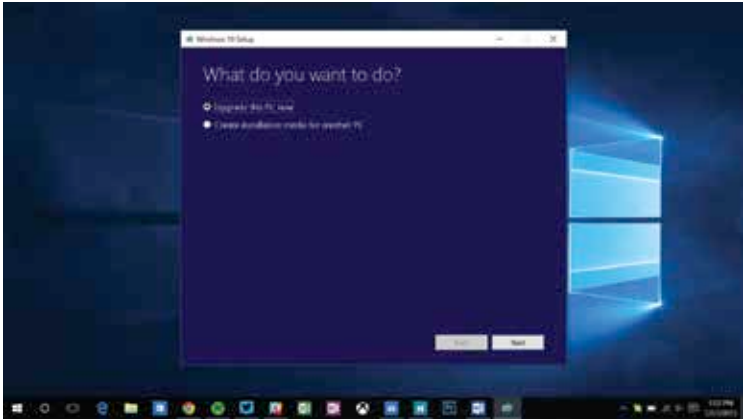




Make sure you select “Upgrade this PC now” if you are upgrading Windows 7/8/8.1

Windows 10 is if you obtained one purchasing a brand new retail copy. You cannot use your Windows 7/8/8.1 product key during the installation.

Microsoft is handling activation slightly differently for PCs upgraded to Windows 10. Your upgraded copy will be associated with a hardware hash that is unique to your system. So once your system is upgraded, you can reinstall Windows 10 on it without having to worry about the product key as Microsoft has stored you PC’s hardware hash in its database as the owner of a legitimate copy of Windows 10.

This, however, raises a serious problem: **If you are upgrading Windows 7/8/8.1 to Windows 10, you CANNOT reinstall Windows 10 on a new system (i.e., new motherboard) without first installing your original, purchased copy of Windows 7/8/8.1. While this is a tedious process, you have to do it only the first time, after which that PC is registered with Windows 10 for life. The catch is that you can only do this till July 29, 2016. So if you want to install Windows 10 on a new PC after that date, you are out of luck since you cannot upgrade your copy of Windows 7/8/8.1 anymore.

To perform a clean install of Windows 10 from an existing OS, ensure you have a blank DVD or USB stick on which the tool can burn the bootable Windows 10 ISO. Run the media creation tool (as mentioned in the previous section) and select “Create installation media for another PC”. Select the correct language, edition, and architecture of the version of Windows you intend to download. Put in your preferred language and correct architecture and select the SAME edition as the one you are upgrading from (Home or Pro).